

Assessment Plan

Handling the Heat: De-escalation Scenarios for Customer-Facing Teams

Type: Embedded, Formative, Criterion-Referenced

Reasoning

Rather than a separate summative quiz at the end of the course, assessment is embedded directly into each scenario: the decision point itself is the assessment item. This mirrors how the skill is actually used on the job — in the moment, under mild pressure — rather than as an abstract recall question.

Why not a traditional quiz?

- This is a soft-skill / judgment-based competency, not a fact-recall competency — authentic scenario practice is a more valid measure than multiple-choice recall questions.
- Unlimited, penalty-free attempts reflect a mastery-learning model: the goal is that every learner leaves able to produce the strong response, not that weaker performers are simply scored lower.
- Immediate, explanatory feedback (the “Why it matters” panel) turns every attempt into a learning moment, not just a pass/fail check.

Objective-to-Assessment Mapping

Objective	Assessed In	Assessment Type	Evaluation Criteria
Terminal Objective	All 4 decision points (Screens 7, 13, 19, 25)	Embedded scenario-based formative assessment	Learner selects the “Strong Response” option in every decision point across the course, on any number of attempts.
EO1	Screen 7 (Scenario 1 decision point)	Embedded branching decision, 3 options	“Strong Response” selected — acknowledges emotion before acting.
EO2	Screen 13 (Scenario 2 decision point)	Embedded branching decision, 3 options	“Strong Response” selected — takes ownership, makes a specific commitment.
EO3	Screen 19 (Scenario 3 decision point)	Embedded branching decision, 3 options	“Strong Response” selected — holds the boundary, offers an alternative.
EO4	Screen 25 (Final Challenge decision point)	Embedded branching decision, 3 options; capstone / integrative	“Strong Response” selected — combines acknowledgment, ownership, and commitment in one message.

Scoring Rubric			
Rating	Criteria	What Triggers This Rating	Learner Path
Not Quite	Response ignores, dismisses, or is likely to <i>escalate</i> the customer's emotion	Commanding the customer ("calm down"), asking them to repeat themselves needlessly, caving to a threat, or a flat refusal with no alternative	Returned to the decision point; unlimited retries, no penalty
Room to Improve	Response is well-intentioned but incomplete	Jumps to a fix without acknowledgment, or gives a vague/non-committal reassurance	Returned to the decision point; unlimited retries, no penalty
Strong Response	Response acknowledges emotion, takes ownership where relevant, and/or offers a concrete path forward	Matches the C.A.L.M. framework	Advances to debrief and next scenario
Assessment Type Summary			
Feature		Approach Used	
Formative vs. Summative		Purely formative — no graded summative test exists in this course	
Attempts		Unlimited, no penalty (mastery-learning model, not norm-referenced scoring)	
Feedback timing		Immediate, after every single response — not batched at the end	
Feedback depth		Explanatory ("Why it matters"), not just correct/incorrect	
Remediation		Built-in — a wrong/partial answer routes back to the same decision point automatically	
Completion criteria		Reaching "Course Complete," which is only reachable after a Strong Response at all 4 points	
Certification/scoring output		None in this version — completion is binary (done / not done), not a numeric score	
What This Course Does <i>Not</i> Measure (and why that's intentional)			
Worth stating explicitly for an SME, since it's often the first question raised:			
• No timed component — speed isn't part of the competency being trained. • No first-attempt-only scoring — this is a training environment, not a certification exam; the goal is mastery, not ranking learners against each other. • No transfer-to-the-job measurement — this module only covers Kirkpatrick Level 2 (Learning). Measuring whether the skill actually shows up in real calls/chats (Level 3) would require a separate mechanism, like manager call scoring using this same 3-tier rubric,			